Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣10

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 10 ♥ K 9 ♦ A 8 7 2 ♣ A 10 9 6	
♠ 6 5 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ J 10 5 ♣ J 8 4 3 2	N W E S	♠ K 3 ♥ Q 6 5 2 ♦ K 9 4 3 ♣ K Q 7
	♠ Q 9 8 7 4 ♥ A J 10 8 3 ♦ Q 6 ♣ 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣K

SOUTH has five cards in each Major and NORTH opens 1NT.

First SOUTH bids 2♥, indicating a 5-card ♠ suit with the Transfer bid. Then, after NORTH bids the obligatory 2♠, SOUTH jumps to 4♥, promising enough strength for game, and also five ♥s to go with the five ♠s.

NORTH prefers ♠s, so she corrects the contract to 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 3 ♥ J 10 5 3 ♦ 10 9 7 4 ♣ A J 9 3	
♠ K Q 5 4 2 ♥ 8 7 ♦ A 8 ♣ Q 7 6 4		♠ A 9 6 ♥ K Q 6 2 ♦ K 5 3 2 ♣ K 8
	♠ J 10 8 7 ♥ A 9 4 ♦ Q J 6 ♣ 10 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3NT	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♦Q

With 12 points and five ♠s, when WEST hears her partner open 1NT she knows there is a game - either 3NT or 4♠.

WEST first transfers EAST to ♠s, then jumps to 3NT, giving EAST the choice.

EAST has three ♠s, so he chooses 4♠, taking the 8-card Major fit.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 7 4 ♥ K Q J 7 5 4 2 ♦ A 9 2 ♣ 9	
♠ A Q 2 ♥ 10 6 ♦ 6 5 4 ♣ 10 8 6 5 4		♠ J 10 9 5 3 ♥ 8 ♦ J 10 7 3 ♣ Q 7 3
	♠ K 8 6 ♥ A 9 3 ♦ K Q 8 ♣ A K J 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣10

After SOUTH opens 2NT, NORTH is pretty sure there will be a slam in ♥s. But, the contract should be played from the SOUTH side so the opening lead doesn't go through any vulnerable ♠ holding SOUTH might have.

NORTH transfers SOUTH to ♥s, then uses Blackwood to be sure they aren't off two Aces. Missing one Ace he settles for 6♥.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 10 2 ♥ 10 8 6 2 ♦ J 10 2 ♣ 8 4 2	
♠ A 6 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ A 6 5 4 ♣ K 10 7	N W E S	♠ K 9 8 5 ♥ Q 7 ♦ K 8 7 ♣ J 9 6 5
	♠ Q 7 4 3 ♥ A 9 4 ♦ Q 9 3 ♣ A Q 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	2NT	
All Pass			

2NT by West
Lead: ♣4

EAST has an invitational hand, (9 points), after WEST's 1NT opening. With a 4-card ♠ suit she uses Stayman.

WEST then shows his 4-card ♥ suit.

With no ♥ fit, EAST can only invite with 2NT, an invitation which WEST declines.